the Indian National Congress in 1935 itself. Land reforms in India had three objectives similar to the other economies which opted for it in the past:

(i) Removing ***institutional discrepancies*** of the agrarian structure inherited from the past which obstructed increasing agricultural production such as—the size of agricultural holding, land ownership, land inheritance, tenancy reforms, abolition of intermediaries, introduction of modern institutional factors to agriculture, etc.

(ii) The other objective of the land reforms in India was related to the issue of ***socio-economic inequality*** in the country. The high level inequality in land ownership had not only its negative economic impact on the economy but it was badly intertwined with caste system of India and the allocation of social prestige and status by the society at large[14]. More than 80 per cent of the population from its livelihood inherited the agrarian system which had inequitable ownership of the asset i.e. land to earn income. The government wanted to go for a restructuring of the land ownership in the economy on the logical grounds and with public welfare approach. This objective of the land reforms got enough socio-political attention as it tried to dismantle the age-old agrarian structure in the country. It became such a hot issue that land reforms in India got a 'bad-name', synonymous to land-grabbing by the government and allotting them to the landless masses.

(iii) The third objective of the land reforms in India was highly contemporary in nature which did not get enough sociopolitical attention—it was the objective of ***increasing agricultural production*** for solving the inter-related problems of poverty, malnutrition and food insecurity.

To realise the objectives of the land reforms, the government took three main steps which had many internal sub-steps:

1. Abolition of Intermediaries

Under this step, the age-old exploitative land tenure systems of the Zamindari, Mahalwari and Ryotwari were fully abolished.